



Elon to depose before Twitter

Elon Musk is set to depose before the Twitter lawyers earlier this week in the deal termination case. <https://digit.in/oct22-23>



Netflix Games adds 'Oxenfree'

Netflix is making the Oxenfree game freely available to its users with a subscription. <https://digit.in/oct22-24>

From novelty to necessity — Here's how TWS earbuds evolved

A look at almost a decade of evolution

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In today's day and age, the market for consumer electronics, especially audio products, has matured to a level which no one could have guessed in ages. Within consumer audio gadgets, True Wireless Earphones, or as we generally call them, TWS earphones, have also seen a huge jump in both technological innovation and their demand in the market.

What started out as a fad-like product line in the world of tech, battling against the trusty old, wired earbuds, has now grown into a mainstay of every conversation regarding wireless audio technology. And the journey from the ground up for wireless earbuds is as interesting as it sounds.

THE FIRST NOTES

As it would be the case with any 'revolutionary' tech innovations in today's time, TWS wireless earbuds could have registered their presence for the first time, either in the booth of a popular audio brand at a tech show or on the Kickstarter page of a brand started by a bunch of innovative misfits if we may call them so. However, tracing back the origins of TWS earbuds is a tough task. This is because the biggest challenge is filtering through the numerous contenders that are out there, staking their claim on being the first ever company to have



made True Wireless Earbuds.

It was around

2014-15 when the buzz started around the tech circles that major players in the market were burning the midnight oil to be the first in the race.

There were Kickstarter campaigns like the one by Bargi LLC. for their Dash earbuds. These earbuds were being sold for \$199 at the time and were equipped with features that would put even some earbuds that are being sold today to shame. Alongside Bargi, earin also launched a Kickstarter campaign for their own TWS earbuds. Despite not being as 'feature-rich' as the offering by Bargi, the earin buds were also successful in creating a buzz around the market. Several



Earin Earbuds

other brands too also came out with their first iterations of TWS earbuds sometime later, and it looked like the journey had started on a positive note.

However, it wasn't smooth sailing for the brands and Kickstarter campaigns. It wasn't long before the first issues started surfacing.

And you guessed it... They were related to irregularities in Bluetooth connectivity. If your tracks on your wireless earbuds skipped a beat in today's time, you'd rush to the brand's Twitter page and shred them to pieces. But you had to bear with connectivity issues when you had limited options. The other weak point for the early TWS offerings were their weak battery life. The Bargi Dash earbuds with 15,998 backers who pledged \$3,390,551 promised only 2-3 hours of playback time. So, there was a lot to be done.

AIRPODS – SETTING STANDARDS

No matter how staunch of an Apple hater you are, you have to accept one thing – They might always show up late to the party, but when they do, they bring it to life. Well, so was the case when Apple first launched their AirPods in 2016. No matter how great the AirPods may look as a product that took the industry forward, they also had their hiccups when it came to first being sent out in the market. They had been announced by Apple alongside the infamous iPhone 7, which is known to be the one that dropped the headphone jack. So, when the voices echoed in the chambers of the internet, the only thing reached everyone's ears – It was the fact that the AirPods were merely a money-making tool for Apple. However, there was also